



TB AUDIO PLUG-INS
Team Impulse Impact

USER MANUAL

TB De-Esser

Level-Independent De-Esser

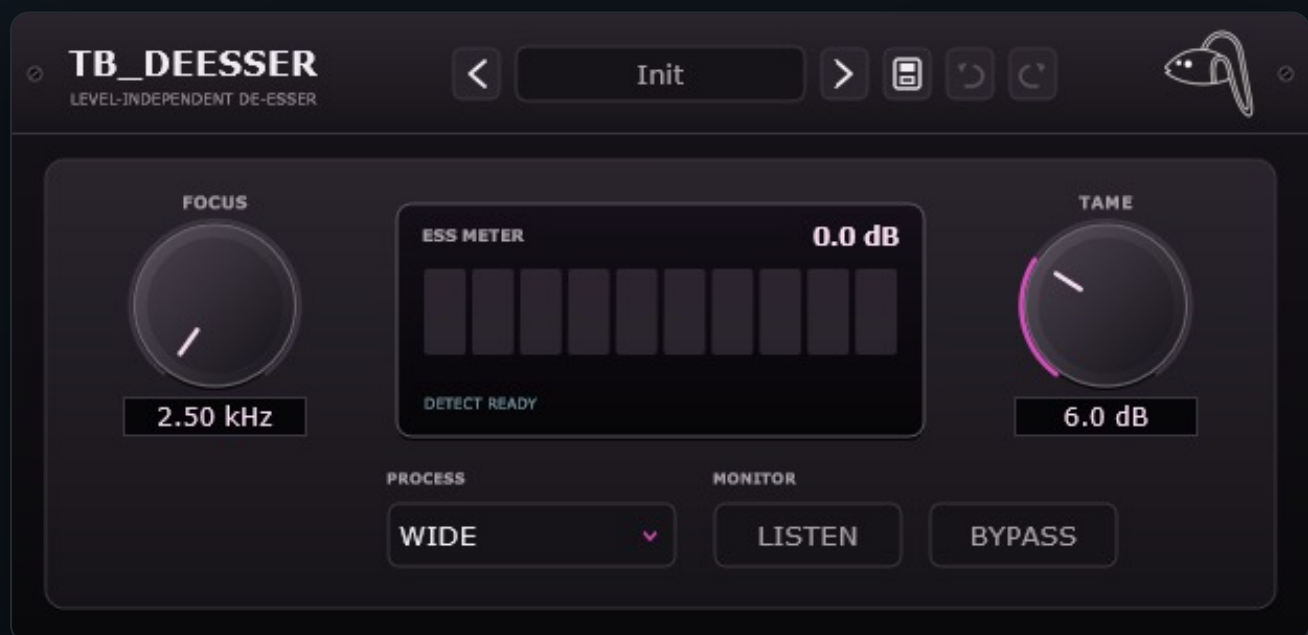
Finds sibilance by its sound rather than its level, and reduces it with a whole-signal dip or stereo-linked spectral cuts, keeping vocal air and diction intact.

Focus 2.5 to 8 kHz

Up to 20 dB reduction

WIDE and SPLIT modes

10 factory presets



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01 Overview

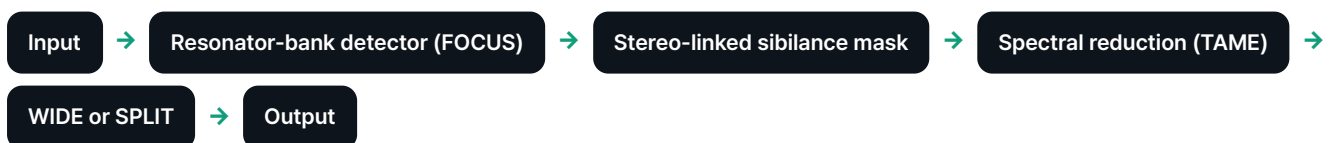
TB De-Esser detects sibilance by its character instead of a level threshold, so it reacts the same way in quiet and loud passages and needs no threshold setting. You tell it where to listen with **FOCUS** and how far to reduce with **TAME**.

The detector is a bank of six resonators weighted around **FOCUS**. The reduction is a separate spectral process, so the detector's filters do not color the output. **PROCESS** chooses whether the whole signal dips (**WIDE**) or only the detected sibilance band is cut (**SPLIT**). Both channels share one sibilance mask, so the stereo image stays stable.

Key features

- Level-independent, language-neutral sibilance detection with no threshold to set
- **FOCUS** from 2.5 to 8 kHz moves the detector's sensitivity centre
- **TAME** sets the maximum reduction, up to 20 dB
- **WIDE** lowers the whole signal; **SPLIT** cuts only inside the detected sibilance band
- Stereo-linked reduction for a stable image
- **LISTEN** to hear the detector signal
- **ESS METER** with gain reduction and detector confidence
- 10 factory presets, user presets, undo, and redo

Signal flow



About this manual

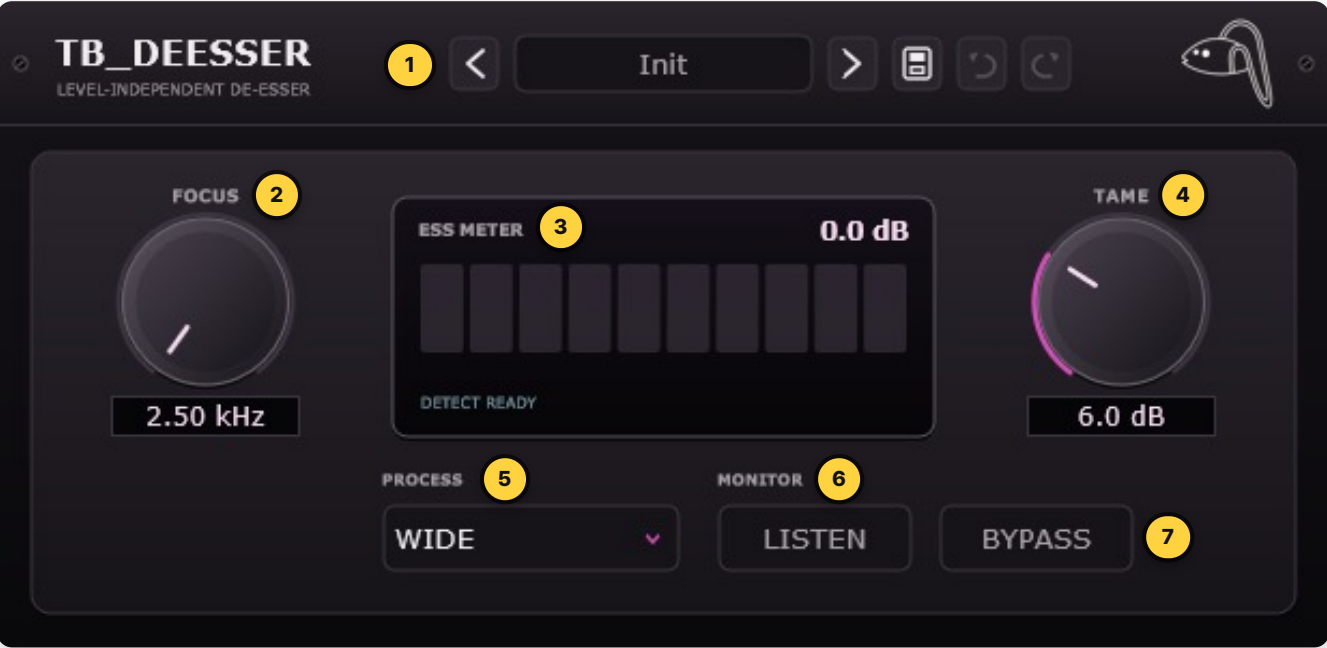
This manual describes TB De-Esser 1.0.0 for Windows (VST3). The current macOS build (AU and VST3) is also version 1.0.0; small differences between platforms are possible.

02 Quick start

- 1 Insert TB De-Esser on a vocal or dialogue track. The defaults are **FOCUS** 2.50 kHz, **TAME** 6.0 dB, and **PROCESS** **WIDE**.

- 2 Play a passage with clear "s" and "sh" sounds and turn on **LISTEN** 6. Move **FOCUS** 2 until you hear mostly the sibilant sounds.
- 3 Turn **LISTEN** off and raise **TAME** 4 until the sibilance sits right, watching the ESS METER 3.
- 4 Compare WIDE and SPLIT with **PROCESS** 5, and check the result against **BYPASS** 7.

03 Interface



TB De-Esser 1.0 interface with the default settings.

- 1 **Preset bar** — previous and next preset (hold to continue), the preset list, Save, Undo, and Redo.

2 **FOCUS** — the detector's sensitivity centre; double-click to reset.

3 **ESS METER** — gain reduction and detector activity.
- 4 **TAME** — the maximum gain reduction.

5 **PROCESS** — WIDE or SPLIT.

6 **LISTEN** — monitors the detector signal.

7 **BYPASS** — compares processed and unprocessed audio.

04 Controls

Control	Range · default	What it does
FOCUS	2.5 to 8 kHz · 2.50 kHz	Moves the resonator bank's sibilance sensitivity centre. It is not an EQ frequency for the output. Double-click to reset.
TAME	0 to 20 dB · 6.0 dB	Sets the maximum gain reduction applied to detected sibilance. High values can over-reduce or smear the sound, so use only as much as you need.
PROCESS	WIDE, SPLIT · WIDE	WIDE lowers the whole signal while sibilance is detected. SPLIT applies stereo-linked spectral cuts only inside the detected sibilance band, so the lows and mids of the voice are left alone.
LISTEN	Off, On · Off	Monitors the Focus-weighted resonator-bank signal instead of the processed output. Use it to set FOCUS, then turn it off.

Control	Range · default	What it does
BYPASS	Off, On · Off	Compares processed and unprocessed audio. The bypassed signal is delayed by the same latency, so the comparison stays in time.

The ESS METER shows the current gain reduction in dB and how confidently the detector hears sibilance; its status line reads DETECT READY in the picture.

Latency

TB De-Esser has a fixed latency of 2048 samples (about 43 ms at 48 kHz), which it reports to the host for delay compensation. BYPASS and TAME 0 dB stay aligned with it, so A/B comparisons line up. Because of the latency it suits mixing and post-production rather than live monitoring.

There is no threshold. Detection does not depend on level, so quiet and loud sibilants are treated alike; TAME sets how much they are reduced.

05 Presets

Step through presets with the arrows (hold to continue), or open the list to choose a factory or saved user preset. Save stores the current state as a .tbdeesser file in the TB_DeEsser user preset folder. Undo and Redo step through parameter and preset changes.

Group	Preset	FOCUS	TAME	PROCESS
VOCAL	Init	2.50 kHz	6.0 dB	WIDE
VOCAL	Gentle Vocal	3.20 kHz	3.0 dB	WIDE
VOCAL	Bright Vocal	4.20 kHz	5.0 dB	WIDE
VOCAL	Low Sibilance	3.20 kHz	5.5 dB	WIDE
VOCAL	Close Mic	2.80 kHz	8.0 dB	WIDE
VOCAL	Whisper Control	5.00 kHz	6.5 dB	SPLIT
VOCAL	Strong Sibilance	2.50 kHz	11.0 dB	WIDE
CONTROL	Split Precision	3.60 kHz	6.0 dB	SPLIT
CONTROL	Guitar Pick	3.00 kHz	7.0 dB	SPLIT
CONTROL	Cymbal Edge	5.20 kHz	4.0 dB	SPLIT

06 Recipes

Starting points for common jobs. Adjust them by ear.

Lead vocal

Natural control of "s" sounds in a pop vocal.

Preset Gentle Vocal

TAME 3 to 6 dB

- 1 Raise TAME only until the sibilants stop jumping out.

Whisper and dialogue

Breathy, close speech with sharp sibilants.

Preset Whisper Control

PROCESS SPLIT

- 1 Use LISTEN to place FOCUS on the hiss of the consonants.

Acoustic guitar pick

Softer pick clicks without dulling the strings.

Preset Guitar Pick

FOCUS around 3 kHz

- 1 Keep SPLIT so the body of the guitar is untouched.

Cymbal edge

Less splash in overheads or a drum bus.

Preset Cymbal Edge

TAME 3 to 5 dB

- 1 Move FOCUS higher if the cymbals still sound harsh.

07 Tips and troubleshooting

Symptom	What to check
The voice sounds lispy or dull.	Lower TAME, or switch PROCESS to SPLIT so only the sibilance band is cut.
The whole vocal ducks on each "s".	That is how WIDE works. Use SPLIT for a more local cut.
Sibilance is not reduced enough.	Raise TAME, and check FOCUS with LISTEN.
The detector reacts to the wrong sounds.	Turn on LISTEN and move FOCUS until you hear mostly the sibilants.
The sound is thin and strange.	LISTEN is on. Turn it off to hear the processed output.
The track is late against others.	TB De-Esser has 2048 samples of latency. Turn on delay compensation in your host; do not use it for live monitoring.

08 Parameter reference

Panel label	Host parameter	Range	Default
FOCUS	Focus	2500 to 8000 Hz	2500 Hz
TAME	Tame	0 to 20 dB	6.0 dB
PROCESS	Mode	Wide, Split	Wide
LISTEN	Listen	Off, On	Off
BYPASS	Bypass	Off, On	Off

09 Version history

Version	Changes
1.0.0 · 2026-08-12	First release: level-independent, language-neutral sibilance detection with stereo-linked spectral reduction; Focus and Tame controls; Wide and Split processing; Listen; bypass; gain-reduction and detector-confidence metering.

10 Support and license

Report problems or request features at github.com/TaebeumKim/TB_Audio-Plugins/issues. Include the plug-in version, your DAW, and your operating system.

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